EXHIBIT A

FULL TEXT OF BALLOT MEASURE

THREE RIVERS UNION ELEMENTARY SCHOOL DISTRICT EDUCATION PROTECTION MEASURE

Since 1928, the Three Rivers Union Elementary School District (the "District") has created an exceptional and rewarding educational environment that integrates the community's natural resources, history, arts, and human capital as foundations for learning. It educates approximately 100 students from transitional kindergarten through eighth grade at its single elementary school campus in the heart of Three Rivers.
Rising costs for utilities, facilities, safety improvements, and day-to-day operations have outpaced the funding the District receives. The District is facing budget cuts due to reduced federal funding from the Department of Education and unstable funding from the State of California that only supports a basic education. State funding struggles to keep pace with the real costs of running a school, particularly a small rural school like Three Rivers Elementary School.

Increases in costs and decreases in revenues will directly impact the District's ability to improve and maintain the Three Rivers Elementary School and its upper athletic fields. The Three Rivers Union Elementary School District's Board of Trustees believes that funding from a local parcel tax measure is needed to stabilize funding for the District and minimize the impact of cost increases and budget cuts on the District's students.

The parcel tax proposed in this Measure, a tax of $120 per parcel per year, would generate approximately $276,000 annually for eight years and would support the District's operations and maintenance costs including but not limited to: utilities, facility/grounds upkeep, safety improvements, and development of a community garden. At least twenty-five percent (25%) of the proposed parcel tax collections from this measure will be set aside for improvements to and maintenance of Three Rivers School's upper athletic fields, an important resource not only to the District but to the entire Three Rivers community. No proceeds from this parcel tax measure will be used for teacher or administrative salaries.

The Measure requires strict fiscal accountability protections to ensure funds are spent as promised, including annual reports and public disclosure of all spending. By law, all funds from the proposed parcel tax Measure must stay local for the District's use only and cannot be taken away by the state or federal governments. The funds generated by this Measure can only be used for the purposes described in the Measure. Importantly, the Measure commits twenty-five percent (25%) of the revenues generated by the parcel tax to costs related to improvements, modernization, maintenance, and safety upgrades of Three Rivers School's upper athletic field to ensure continued safe access for the District's students and community members.

The proposed parcel tax is temporary, will automatically expire in eight years, and cannot be renewed without voter approval.

SUMMARY STATEMENT OF THE MEASURE

To offset inflation and limited state funding, shall the Three Rivers Union Elementary School District's measure to levy a $120 parcel tax for eight years (raising approximately $276,000 annually) to fund school operations and maintenance costs including utilities; facility/grounds upkeep/safety improvements, and a community garden, with no money used for teacher or administrative salaries and setting aside at least 25% for improvements to and maintenance of Three Rivers School's upper athletic fields for community use during non-school hours, be adopted??

PURPOSE OF THE MEASURE

The District proposes to levy and collect the parcel tax annually for eight (8) years as more fully described below under the heading "RATE AND PROCEDURE," and to implement accountability measures in connection with the parcel tax to ensure that funds are used only for the following specific purposes:

To fund school operations and maintenance costs including but not limited to:

> Costs related to the District's facilities and grounds maintenance, utilities and operational costs, costs of safety improvements and infrastructure repairs, the purchase of instructional materials and educational technology, the development of a community garden, and costs related to custodial, maintenance, and operational support expenses.

To provide for improvements, modernization, maintenance, and safety upgrades to Three Rivers School's upper athletic fields including but not limited to:

> Field grading, irrigation, drainage, turf or surface improvements, fencing, accessibility improvements, lighting, and improvements to spectator areas.

RATE AND PROCEDURE

Amount of Parcel Tax. Subject to two-thirds approval of the voters, this local funding measure and its parcel tax will be in effect for eight (8) years, commencing July 1, 2027. The parcel tax will be levied on each parcel of taxable real property (except exempt parcels, as described below), at the rate of $120 per parcel each year.

Method of Collection. The parcel tax will be collected by the Tulare County Tax Collector (the "County Tax Collector") at the same time as and along with, and will be subject to the same penalties as, general *ad valorem* taxes collected by said County Tax Collector. The tax and penalty will bear interest at the same rate as the rate for unpaid *ad valorem* property taxes until paid. Any tax levied will become a lien upon the properties against which taxes are assessed and collectible as herein provided.

The Board of Trustees of the District may adopt such additional or supplemental procedures as it deems necessary or convenient for the administration of the parcel tax.

Definition of Parcel. A "parcel of taxable real property" is defined as any unit of real property within the District's boundaries that receives a separate tax bill for *ad valorem* property taxes from the County Tax Collector. Units of real property may be treated as separate parcels of taxable real property if a separate parcel number, assessment number, or similar designation is assigned them by the County Assessor.

Exemptions. All property that is otherwise exempt from property taxes levied in any year will also be exempt from the parcel tax in such year.

With respect to all general property tax matters within its jurisdiction, the County Tax Collector or other appropriate County tax official shall make all final determinations of tax exemption or relief for any reason, and that decision shall be final and binding. With respect to matters specific to the levy of the special tax, including the application of the definition of "parcel of taxable real property" to any parcel(s) or any other disputed matter specific to the application of the special tax, the decisions of the District shall be final and binding.

APPROPRIATIONS LIMIT

To the extent required by the California Constitution and applicable laws, the appropriations limit for the District will be adjusted periodically by the aggregate sum collected by levy of this special tax.

ACCOUNTABILITY AND COMPLIANCE MEASURES

In accordance with California Government Code sections 50075.1 and 50075.3, and as additionally proscribed by the Board of Trustees of the District, the following accountability measures shall apply to the parcel tax levied in accordance with this Measure:

(a) The proceeds of the education parcel tax shall be applied only to the specific purposes identified under the heading "PURPOSE OF THE MEASURE," above.

(b) The proceeds of the special tax shall be deposited into a fund, which shall be kept separate and apart from other funds of the District.

(c) No later than January 1 of each year while the parcel tax is in effect, the chief fiscal officer of the District shall prepare and file with the Board of Trustees of the District a report detailing the amount of funds collected and expended, and the status of any project, programs, or purposes identified under the heading "PURPOSE OF THE MEASURE," above.

(d) At least twenty-five percent (25%) of the proceeds of the parcel tax shall be set aside exclusively for costs related to improvements, modernization, maintenance, and safety upgrades to Three Rivers School's upper athletic fields.

PROTECTION OF FUNDING

Current law forbids any decrease in State or federal funding to the District resulting from the adoption of a parcel tax. However, if any such funding is reduced or affected because of the adoption of this local funding measure, then the Board may reduce the amount of the special taxes levied as necessary in order to restore such State or federal funding and/or maximize the District's fiscal position for the benefit of the District's educational programs. As a result, whether directly or indirectly, no funding from this Measure may be taken away by the State or federal governments.

SEVERABILITY

The Board of Trustees of the District hereby declares, and the voters by approving this Measure concur, that every section, paragraph, sentence and clause of this Measure has independent value, and the Board of Trustees and the voters would have adopted each provision hereof regardless of every other provision hereof. Upon approval of this Measure by the voters, should any part be found by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid for any reason, all remaining parts hereof shall remain in full force and effect to the fullest extent allowed by law.